

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Please provide project title
<i>Company:</i>	MHR

Contact Details

<i>Lead Contact:</i>	Ashley Diggle
<i>Lead E-mail:</i>	Ashley.diggle@mhrglobal.com
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Anthony Simpson
<i>E-mail:</i>	Anthony.simpson@mhrglobal.com
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Alex Brown
<i>E-mail:</i>	Alex.Brown@mhrglobal.com
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Richard Maltby
<i>E-mail:</i>	Richard.Maltby@mhrglobal.com

Additional Info

<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐
	If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Click or tap here to enter text.

Project Background Information

MHR has an enterprise HR and Payroll application which is used by organisations of 100 to 4,000+ employees. It is used to manage and support an organisation's most valuable asset: their people. From recruitment and onboarding through to HR, learning, workforce management, engagement, performance, pay and finance, our software supports the entire employee lifecycle.

Recruitment teams are facing a rapidly changing hiring landscape. High applicant-to-job ratios mean organisations can receive significant numbers of applications for a single vacancy, increasing the time and effort required to identify suitable candidates. At the same time, candidates are increasingly using AI tools to create and refine CVs and applications, making it more difficult for recruiters to understand an individual's genuine experience, skills and suitability from traditional application materials alone.

Augmented screening and interviews provide an opportunity to rethink this process. By introducing structured questions, automated screening and digital interview experiences earlier in the recruitment journey, organisations could

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

capture richer and more authentic information about candidates while reducing the administrative burden placed on recruitment teams.

However, introducing AI and automation into recruitment also creates important challenges. Solutions must support fair and inclusive recruitment practices, comply with emerging AI regulation and data protection requirements, and provide candidates with a transparent and positive experience. Organisations must also consider how AI should be configured for different roles and where human judgement should remain part of the recruitment process.

This project will explore the end-to-end experience of augmented screening and interviewing, from how an organisation sets up and configures the process through to the candidate completing an application or interview and the recruiter reviewing the resulting information.

A key area to explore is what happens to the rich data captured through an augmented interview. Rather than simply producing another application for a recruiter to review, consider how interview responses, transcripts and other captured information could be transformed into meaningful insights that help recruiters make faster, better-informed and fairer decisions.

Project objectives:

1. **Design the employer setup and configuration experience**, considering how augmented screening and interviews could be configured for different vacancies, roles and candidate requirements, including the appropriate use and configuration of AI.
2. **Design and create the AI prompt that powers the augmented interview experience**, including how the system instructs the AI to ask questions, adapt to different roles, and capture candidate responses in a structured and consistent way.
3. **Create a compelling candidate experience** that is simple, accessible and transparent, encouraging candidates to complete the process while enabling them to demonstrate their genuine skills, experience and suitability for the role.
4. **Turn interview data into useful recruiter insights**. Explore how transcripts, responses and other information captured during the process could be analysed, summarised and presented to recruiters. Consider what recruiters need to understand about a candidate and how the system could help them compare, shortlist or identify candidates for further review.
5. **Design the end-to-end recruiter experience**, considering what happens after candidates have completed the process. Explore how recruiters could review outcomes, understand AI-generated insights, identify areas requiring human judgement and determine the next action in the recruitment journey.

Throughout the project, consider candidate trust and transparency, accessibility and inclusion, fair recruitment practices, privacy and data protection, AI regulation, explainability and human oversight.

The goal is not simply to automate an existing recruitment process, but to explore how richer candidate data and responsible use of AI could create a better experience for candidates while helping recruitment teams identify the right people more efficiently.

Requirements

The group must provide:

You must demonstrate a system as to how a hiring manager or recruiter defines the "rules of engagement" for the AI.

You must show the "brain" of the operation. This is the technical logic that ensures consistency regardless of the candidate. This will include a documented System Prompt Library and logic flow

Your design must prove that AI can be "transparent and positive" rather than cold or robotic. Include a user journey flow (wireframes and high-level designs).

Finally, you must define where the technology ends and the human begins.

Skills

Highly desirable:

*AI Engineering & Prompt Design
Responsible AI, Ethics & Compliance
Product & UX/UI Design*

Desirable:

HR Domain & Assessment Science

Submission / Award information

Date of Submission:

September 2026

Date of Pitch:

October 2026

Notification of award:

October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.